EK E Khwatenge

Business Skills for TVET Students: From Idea to Simple Business Plan

Ever wondered how your technical skills can turn into a profitable venture? This course guides you step by step from identifying business opportunities in your trade area to building a simple, actionable business plan. You'll explore what makes a business work, connect your skills to real-world needs, and discover how to create value for your customers. By the end, you'll be ready to draft your own one-page business plan and take the first steps toward entrepreneurship.

- Understanding What a Business Is
- Identifying and Shaping Your Business Idea
- Building a Simple Business Model
- Drafting a One-Page Business Plan
- Review, Knowledge Check, and Next Steps

Lesson 1 of 5

Understanding What a Business Is

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Welcome: What Is a Business?

Welcome to your first step into the world of entrepreneurship! In this lesson, you'll discover what a business really is and how your own TVET skills can be the foundation for a successful venture. By the end, you'll see how your talents can connect to real opportunities in your community and beyond.

This lesson will help you understand the basics of what a business is, explore examples of small businesses in your local area, and learn about the essential elements that make up every business.

1. Define what a business is.
2. Identify examples of small businesses in your trade area.
3. Recognize the four key elements of every business.

CONTINUE

A business is an activity where you provide products or services to customers in exchange for money. For TVET graduates, this can be a salon, welding workshop, small café, mobile repair shop, online baking business, or any service that solves a problem for people. A good business starts with a clear problem, a solution, and customers who are willing to pay for it. In this lesson, you will connect your technical skills to real business opportunities in your community.

Core Parts of Every Business

Understanding the essential components of a business helps you build a strong foundation. Here are the four core parts that every business needs to consider:

Product/Service

The main thing you offer, such as repairing phones, baking cakes, or hairdressing.

Customer

The people who buy from you, like students, neighbours, local shops, or offices.

Value

The problem you solve for your customers, such as saving time, improving appearance, or fixing broken items.

Payment

How you earn money, whether it's cash, mobile money, subscription, or a per-service fee.

TVET Skills in Action: Real Businesses in Your Community

Discover how Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET) skills can be transformed into thriving businesses that serve your local community.

Cosmetology

A graduate opens a mobile hairdressing service, visiting clients at home.

This flexible approach allows them to reach more customers and offer convenience.

Electrical

A small team offers home wiring and safety checks.

They help families and businesses stay safe and keep their electricity running smoothly.

Hospitality

A student delivers homemade snacks to local offices.

This business meets the need for quick, tasty food during busy workdays.

Automotive

A mechanic provides on-site motorcycle repairs.

Customers save time and effort by getting help where they need it most.

Every business, whether large or small, begins with the same fundamental elements: a product or service to offer, customers to serve, value to provide, and a method of receiving payment.

Which statement best describes a business?

- A place where people meet socially.
- An activity that provides products or services to customers in

exchange for money.

- Any government-funded training center.
- A group of friends with similar interests.

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CONTINUE

You've just learned what a business is, explored examples from different TVET fields, and discovered the four essential building blocks of any business. In the next lesson, you'll learn how to spot business opportunities using your own technical skills and the needs in your community.

Lesson 2 of 5

Identifying and Shaping Your Business Idea

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Finding Your Business Idea

Welcome to this lesson on turning your technical skills into real business opportunities. Here, you'll learn how to spot needs in your community and match them with what you can offer. By the end, you'll be ready to start shaping your own business idea.

This lesson will help you understand how to connect your technical and vocational skills to potential business opportunities, recognize needs within your community, and develop an initial business idea that leverages your abilities to address those needs.

1. Link your TVET skills to possible business opportunities.
2. Identify real needs in your community that you can address.
3. Formulate a preliminary business idea that connects your skills and community needs.

CONTINUE

Every successful business begins by aligning your strengths with the needs of others. To discover a solid business idea, consider these questions: What skills have you gained from your training? What challenges do people in your community encounter? In what ways can your skills address these challenges? The responses to these questions form the basis of a strong business concept.

Turning Skills into Business Ideas

Discover how your existing skills can be transformed into profitable business opportunities. Here are some examples to inspire you:

Hairdressing

Offer mobile salon services for busy clients, bringing hairdressing directly to their homes or workplaces.

Electrical Installation

Provide home wiring and safety checks to ensure households are safe and up to code.

Catering

Deliver office lunches or snacks, catering to businesses and professionals looking for convenient meal options.

Automotive Repair

Start an on-site motorcycle repair service, offering convenience to clients by servicing their

vehicles at their location.

Great business ideas often arise when you combine your strengths and skills with the needs of people in your community.

Match Skills to Business Ideas

Match each skill to a business idea that addresses a real-world need. Drag each skill to the business idea it best fits.

Mobile salon services for busy clients

Hairdressing

Home wiring and safety checks

Electrical installation

Office lunch delivery

Catering

On-site motorcycle repair service

Automotive repair

Which question should you ask first when finding a business idea?

- ◯ What am I good at (from my course)?
- ◯ What is the most expensive product I can sell?
- ◯ How many shops are already in my area?

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CONTINUE

Take a moment to reflect on your personal skills and the specific needs you observe in your community. Your unique blend of talents and understanding of local issues can inspire a meaningful business idea. Consider one way in which your abilities could benefit those around you.

Your business idea will be most successful when it is grounded in your genuine skills and addresses real needs that people have.

Using my skills in electrical installation, I would start a business offering affordable and reliable home wiring and electrical maintenance services to homeowners and small businesses who struggle to find trustworthy electricians.

CONTINUE

In this lesson, you learned how to spot business opportunities by connecting your skills to real needs in your community. Next, you will discover how to turn your idea into a simple business model by breaking it down into customers, value, costs, and revenue.

Lesson 3 of 5

Building a Simple Business Model

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Turning Your Idea Into a Simple Business Model

Welcome to this lesson! Now that you have a business idea, it's time to learn how to organize it into a simple, clear structure. You'll discover four essential building blocks that help turn your idea into a real plan. By the end of this lesson, you'll see how these parts work together to make your business idea stronger and easier to launch.

This lesson will help you understand the essential components of a business model and how to use them to plan your ideas effectively.

1. Name four key business model parts.
2. Break down your idea into these parts.
3. Explain how this model helps planning.

CONTINUE

A business model is a simple way to describe how your business works. No matter what kind of business you want to start, you can understand it by answering four questions: Who are your customers? What value do you offer them? What costs will you have? How will you make revenue? Thinking about these questions helps you see your idea clearly and plan for success.

The Four Building Blocks of a Simple Business Model

Understanding the basic components of a business model is essential for any entrepreneur. Here are the four key building blocks you need to consider when starting a business.

Customers: Who will buy from you?

Customers are the people or organizations who purchase your products or services. Identifying your target customers helps you focus your marketing and sales efforts.

Value: What problem do you solve for them?

Value refers to the solution or benefit your business provides to customers. It answers the question of why customers should choose your product or service over others.

Costs: What do you spend money on to run the business?

Costs are the expenses required to operate your business, such as rent, salaries, materials, and marketing. Understanding your costs is crucial for managing profitability.

Revenue: How do you earn money?

Revenue is the income your business generates from selling products or services. Knowing your revenue streams helps you plan for growth and sustainability.

Business Model Examples for TVET Ideas

Expand each example to see how the four building blocks apply to real businesses. Notice how each part connects to the others to create a complete picture.

Mobile Hairdressing

- **Customers:** Busy clients at home
- **Value:** Saves time, provides convenience
- **Costs:** Travel, tools, hair products
- **Revenue:** Per-visit fee

Home Wiring Service

- **Customers:** Local households
- **Value:** Safe, reliable electricity
- **Costs:** Tools, transport, supplies
- **Revenue:** Service charges

Snack Delivery

- **Customers:** Office workers, students
- **Value:** Fresh, convenient snacks
- **Costs:** Ingredients, packaging, transport
- **Revenue:** Price per snack

A clear business model allows you to determine whether your idea is viable and identifies the resources and steps needed for success.

Sort Items into Business Model Parts

Review each item and decide which part of the business model it belongs to: Customers, Value, Costs, or Revenue. This exercise will help you understand how to categorize key elements of a business idea.

Customers

Students buying snacks

Busy office workers

Value

Fresh, tasty food at break time

Safe, working electrical systems

Costs

Flour, oil, transport

Tools and supplies

Revenue

Money earned from snack sales

Service charges

Who are the customers in the catering student's snack business?

- Her family
- College students
- Her suppliers
- Local shop owners

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CONTINUE

In this lesson, you learned how to break down any business idea into four clear parts: customers, value, costs, and revenue. This simple model helps you plan and test your idea before starting. In the next lesson, you'll learn how to organize your answers into a one-page business plan, making your business idea ready to share and launch.

Lesson 4 of 5

Drafting a One-Page Business Plan

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Turn Your Idea Into a Simple Business Plan

Welcome to this lesson! You're about to take a big step—organizing your business idea into a clear, actionable plan. A one-page business plan is a simple tool that helps you turn your idea into reality. It makes it easy to start, share, and improve your business as you grow. Let's get started on making your plan!

In this lesson, you'll learn how to turn your business idea into a simple, one-page plan. You'll use a step-by-step template and see clear examples for each part. By the end, you'll be ready to create your own plan and take action.

1. Organize your business idea.
2. Use a step-by-step template.
3. Describe each key part.

CONTINUE

A business plan is like a map for your business journey. It helps you focus your ideas, spot any missing pieces, and explain your plan to others—like trainers, partners, or funders. For new entrepreneurs, a one-page plan is especially helpful because it's quick to create and easy to update as you learn. In this lesson, you'll build your plan step by step, making sure each part is clear and practical.

How to Complete a One-Page Business Plan

This guide will walk you through the five essential steps to create a simple, effective one-page business plan.

Introduction to the One-Page Business Plan

A one-page business plan helps you clarify your business idea quickly and simply. By following these steps, you'll have a clear overview of your business that's easy to share and update.

Step 2

Choose your business name

Pick a name that reflects what your business does and is easy to remember. This helps people recognize and talk about your business.

Step 3

Describe your product or service

Write a short sentence about what you offer. Focus on what makes your product or service special or useful to customers.

Step 4

Identify your main customers

Think about who will buy from you. Be specific—consider age, job, location, or lifestyle.

Step 5

Explain the value you offer

Describe the main benefit or solution your business provides. What problem do you solve for your customers?

Step 6

List your main costs and pricing

Write down your top expenses (like materials, tools, or transport) and how much you will charge for your product or service.

Review your plan

Look over your answers. Make sure each part is clear and connects to the others. Your plan should be simple, honest, and ready to share.

Examples for Each Part of the Business Plan

Expand each section below to see how a real business might fill out each part of a one-page plan. These examples are based on common TVET business ideas and can help you think about your own answers.

Business Name

Bright Touch Mobile Salon

This name is short, easy to remember, and tells customers what the business does.

Product or Service

We offer at-home hairdressing and grooming for busy professionals and students.

This describes exactly what the business provides and who it helps.

Main Customers

Working adults, students, and parents in our neighborhood.

The business is clear about who it serves, making it easier to focus marketing and services.

Value Offered

We save customers time by bringing salon services to their doorstep, helping them look their best without travel.

This shows the main benefit and problem solved for the customer.

Main Costs & Pricing

Costs: hair products, transport, tools. Pricing: 500 KES per visit.

This lists the main expenses and how much the business charges for its service.

Test your understanding: What goes in each part of the plan?

Review each flashcard to check if you remember what belongs in every section of your one-page business plan. These prompts will help you prepare your own answers.

Business Name

The service, uniqueness, or location should be reflected in your business name.

Product or Service

Briefly describe what you offer to your customers in one clear sentence.

Main Customers

Identify your primary buyers or users—be as specific as possible.

Value Offered

State the main problem you solve or the benefit you provide to your customers.

Main Costs & Pricing

List your key expenses and explain how you will set your price.

A clear and simple plan acts as your roadmap, guiding you to start with manageable steps, grow consistently, and adjust as you gain new insights.

Now it's your turn! Complete your own one-page business plan using the five steps above. Use the online fill-in-the-blank fields or download the worksheet to work offline. Keep your answers short and honest—this plan is for you, so make it practical and real.

Tips for Planning Each Section

Expand each tab for practical advice as you fill out your business plan. These tips will help you avoid common mistakes and build confidence in your answers.

BUSINESS NAME	PRODUCT/SERVICE	CUSTOMERS	VALUE	COS

Choose a name that is easy to spell and say. It should give people a quick idea of what your business does.

Test your name with friends or family to see if it's memorable. Avoid names that are too long or hard to pronounce.

BUSINESS NAME	PRODUCT/SERVICE	CUSTOMERS	VALUE	COS

Focus on what you do best and how it helps people. Be clear and avoid using technical jargon that customers may not understand.

Think about what makes your product or service different from others. Highlight any special skills or features you offer.

BUSINESS NAME	PRODUCT/SERVICE	CUSTOMERS	VALUE	COS

Be as specific as possible about who your customers are. Consider their age, job, location, and daily routines.

Knowing your customers well helps you market your business and meet their needs more effectively.

BUSINESS NAME	PRODUCT/SERVICE	CUSTOMERS	VALUE	COS

Describe the main benefit or solution you provide. Focus on how your business makes life easier or better for your customers.

A strong value statement is clear and direct. It should answer the question: Why should someone choose your business?

BUSINESS NAME	PRODUCT/SERVICE	CUSTOMERS	VALUE	COS

List your top 2–3 expenses, such as materials, tools, or transport. Be realistic about what you need to spend to run your business.

When setting your price, consider your costs and what customers are willing to pay. Start simple and adjust as you learn more.

Which of these is a strong value statement for a mobile salon business?

- ◯ We are the cheapest in town.
- ◯ We help busy clients look great without leaving home.
- ◯ We have a nice logo.
- ◯ Our shop is near the market.

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CONTINUE

In this lesson, you learned how to organize your business idea into a one-page plan. With your plan drafted, you're ready to review, refine, and share it with others. In the next (and final) lesson, you'll review key concepts, check your understanding, and get practical tips for moving forward as a new entrepreneur.

Lesson 5 of 5

Review, Knowledge Check, and Next Steps

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Wrapping Up: Review & Your Next Steps

Welcome to the final lesson of this course! Here, you'll revisit the main ideas you've learned, check your understanding, and discover practical advice for moving forward with your business plans. This is your opportunity to consolidate your learning and build confidence as you take your next steps toward entrepreneurship.

This lesson will help you bring together everything you've learned about business, business ideas, models, and planning. You'll test your knowledge, reflect on your progress, and get ready to take action on your business journey.

1. Recall key business concepts.
2. Check your understanding.
3. Identify practical next steps.

CONTINUE

Lesson Review: Key Business Concepts

Let's review the essential concepts covered in each lesson about starting and understanding a business.

What is a business?

A business provides products or services to customers in exchange for money, solving real problems or needs.

How do you find a business idea?

Start by matching your skills with real needs in your community to create a valuable solution.

What are the four parts of a business model?

Customers, value offered, costs, and revenue are the four essential building blocks of any business model.

What goes into a one-page business plan?

A business name, product or service, main customers, value offered, and main costs and pricing make up a simple plan.

Which of the following are key parts of a simple business model?

- [ ] Customers
- [ ] Value offered
- [ ] Favourite colour
- [ ] Costs
- [ ] Revenue

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True or False? A good business idea always starts with what you are good at and what people need.

- ( ) True
- ( ) False

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Sort Business Model Components

Review your understanding of business model components by sorting each item into the right category. Think carefully about what each item represents in a real business.

Customers

Busy parents needing quick meals

Value

Affordable, healthy dinners delivered at home

Costs

Groceries, packaging, delivery fuel

Revenue

Money earned from food sales

Describe your own TVET-related business idea and how it creates value for customers in 2–3 sentences.

☐ Sample Answer 1: Mobile Auto Repair Service

- [ ] Sample Answer 2: Online Plumbing Training Platform
- [ ] Sample Answer 3: Solar Panel Installation for Rural Homes

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CONTINUE

What Should You Do Next?

Expand each tab to see practical actions you can take after this course. Each step will help you refine your plan and grow as an entrepreneur.

REFINE YOUR PLAN | TEST YOUR IDEA | LEARN AND ADAPT | CONNECT WITH OTHERS

Take another look at your one-page business plan. Ask a trainer, mentor, or a trusted peer to review it and give you honest feedback.

Use their suggestions to make your plan clearer and stronger. Remember, improvement is part of the process for every entrepreneur.

REFINE YOUR PLAN | TEST YOUR IDEA | LEARN AND ADAPT | CONNECT WITH OTHERS

Start small by offering your product or service to a few people. Pay attention to their reactions and ask for their opinions.

This real-world feedback will help you see what works and what needs adjustment before you grow your business.

REFINE YOUR PLAN	TEST YOUR IDEA	LEARN AND ADAPT	CONNECT WITH OTHERS

Every experience, even mistakes, is a chance to learn. Be open to changing your plan as you discover what your customers really want.

Keep updating your business plan and approach as you gain more knowledge and confidence.

REFINE YOUR PLAN	TEST YOUR IDEA	LEARN AND ADAPT	CONNECT WITH OTHERS

Join groups or networks for young entrepreneurs in your trade area. Sharing experiences and advice can help you solve problems and find new opportunities.

Building relationships with others in business can open doors and provide valuable support as you grow.

Your journey as an entrepreneur is just beginning. Every small step you take builds your skills, confidence, and business success.

Congratulations on completing the course! You've learned how to identify business opportunities, build a simple business model, and create a one-page business plan. Remember to use feedback, keep refining your ideas, and support each other as you launch your ventures. We wish you every success in your entrepreneurial journey!